

Tessa the Shy Tortoise

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Tessa was a little tortoise.

She was very shy.

New places made her tuck into her shell.

One day, there was a party at the pond.

All the pond animals were invited.

Tessa felt shy.

Her feet felt slow.

Her voice felt tiny.

"What if no one talks to me?" she worried.

Mama Tortoise walked with her to the pond.

She said, "I see you feel shy."

Tessa nodded.

"It is okay to feel shy," Mama said.



"Being shy just means you warm up slowly."

Tessa liked that.

Warm up slowly.

Like sunshine on her shell.

At the pond, music was playing.

Frogs were hopping.

Ducks were dancing.

Tessa tucked her head in a little.

Then she saw a small frog sitting alone.

The frog looked shy too.

Tessa took one slow step.

Then another slow step.

"Hello," she said in her tiny voice.

"Hello," said the frog.

"My name is Remy."

"I am Tessa," said Tessa.



They sat together by the water.
They watched the dancers.
They shared some lettuce.
Remy told a funny joke.
Tessa giggled.
Her shell felt warm.
Her voice felt bigger.
They played a slow game of bubbles.
One bubble.
Two bubbles.
Three bubbles.
Pop!
Tessa felt happy.

She had made a friend.

Mama Tortoise smiled from far away.

She whispered, "You did it, my brave girl."

That night, Tessa snuggled into her soft moss bed.

She thought about Remy.



She thought about the bubbles.

She felt shy earlier.

Now she felt proud and warm.

The pond sang its night song.

Croak, croak, hush.

Tessa closed her eyes.

She was cozy.

She was loved.

Goodnight, Tessa.

Moral: *Shy is okay — one small hello can grow into a friend.*

The End